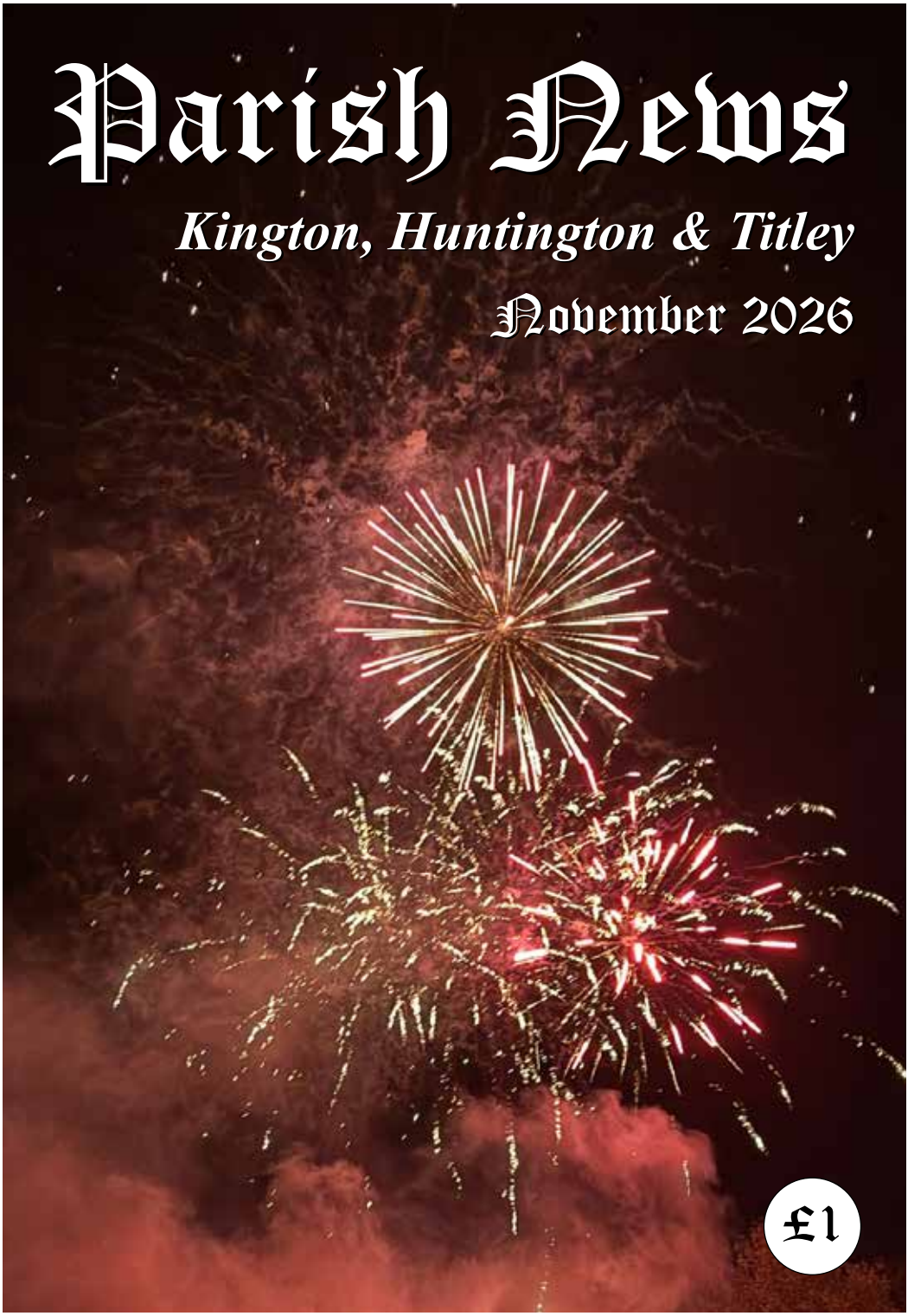
Parish News

Kington, Huntington & Titley

November 2026



£1

THE KINGTON PARISHES



St Mary, Kington; St Thomas a Becket, Huntington
St Stephen, Old Radnor; St Mary, Kinnerton; St Peter, Titley
www.kingtonparishes.org.uk

CLERGY

Rev. Canon Dr. Sally Welch The Vicarage, Church Road, Kington HR5 3AG
email: vicar@kingtonparishes.org.uk 07974 439630

Curate
Rev. Phillippa Wright pipwright23@gmail.com

Enquiries contact: Parish Office email: office@kingtonparishes.org.uk

ASSISTANT CLERGY
Rev Tony Jardine 9 Park Green, Kington 01544 239160
Rev Paul Buckingham Cae Pengelli, Bryngwyn, Kington HR5 3QL 07557 301005

READER
Rob MacCurrach 33 Cutterbach Lane, Kington, HR5 3EH 01544 231848

CHURCHWARDENS
Kington Mrs Margaret Cooke 01544 230805
25 Church St, Kington HR5 3BE stmarys.kington.churchwarden@gmail.com
Greg Wright magicobject@gmail.com

Huntington Mrs Fiona Shone 07515 741999
Huntington Court, Huntington, Kington, HR5 3PZ
Mr Peter Kelly 01544 370266
Greenfield Farm, Huntington, Kington HR5 3PZ

Old Radnor Mrs Rosemary Watkins 01544 230174
Dunfield Bungalow, Stanner Rd, Kington HR5 3NN

Kinnerton Mrs Ruth Jones:
Upper House, Kinnerton, Presteigne, LD8 2PE 01547 560207
Mrs Sue Thompson
Court Farm, Kinnerton, Presteigne, LD8 2PE 01547 560333

Titley Mr Dick Allford 01544 231052
Pinecroft, Titley, Kington, HR5 3RL

SUBMISSIONS EDITOR
Mr David Redmayne 01544 239003
10 The Square, Kington, HR5 3BA pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

DIARY EDITOR
Rev Paul Roberts 07989 265272
Rev.Paul.C.Roberts@gmail.com

St. Mary's, Kington PCC is a registered charity and its number is 1185453

Cover: Fireworks Kington Recreation Ground

Notes from the Curate



I am probably one of the last generations who were sent by their parents to Sunday School. My generation is probably also the last that attended schools which held daily assemblies including worship songs and prayers. Despite this, like most teenagers, my faith waivered when I was in my late teens.

It was not until I met my current husband that my faith was reignited. We went to a local community Church where I was welcomed despite being a divorced single parent. Not long after, I had a moment where I felt called to ministry. Not feeling worthy or sufficiently equipped, I ignored this for a number of years. Our circumstances changed and notion of ministry emerged again.

The "call to ministry" is tested in what the CofE like to call a discernment process. Firstly, I had to demonstrate that I had the vocational potential in my local parish. This involved leading prayers, taking part in Bible study, contributing towards Children's ministry, demonstrating a desire to serve (doing the washing up) and preaching! I remember climbing the steps to the pulpit for the first time, knees knocking and sweaty palms. Preaching still makes me nervous.

Having done all this, you are then put forward for selection. A very long job interview! This involves psychological assessment. Then stage 1 interview (6 zoom where you describe how you meet the ministerial qualities and are then asked questions). The stage 2 interview is a weekend residential where you undertake more interviews, group work and all your interactions are observed! At some point you have an interview with the bishop.

Success means starting theological training. Three years of part-time education involving numerous essays, weekend residentials and Easter "retreats". All this whilst still contributing to parish ministry. Finally, you attend another interview with the bishop and if all goes well become ordained Deacon.

Why doe the CofE go to such lengths? Firstly, to make sure as far as possible that you are a person who can be trusted with the office of Deacon/Priest. Someone who will demonstrate a Christlike character and can be trusted with the welfare of others. Just in case this isn't enough, the CofE now has a robust safeguarding policy too. Safeguarding and DBS checks can sometimes feel like a burden, but they are intended to try and keep people safe (volunteers and participants). We cannot escape the history of abuse but can try to do everything possible to prevent it in the future.

Secondly to make sure that as a person you have a robust enough constitution to handle the rigors of ministerial life. As ministers we are with people in the times of greatest joy and greatest sadness (marriage and funerals), but we are also in parish every day, trying to maintain not only the upkeep of the church building but also the body of Christ.

In my teenage years I wandered away from Church because I did not have the spiritual maturity to see that what matters is not what I want out of life but the way I live my life. The journey to ordination reflects something of the selfless nature of what it means to be a true follower of Christ.

Phillipa

From the Bishop of Hereford



Tanzania 2026

As I write this, I have just returned from a visit to our link diocese in Tanzania. We visited the Diocese of Masasi in the south of the country which celebrated its 100th anniversary at the end of September. It was an experience both joyful and gruelling in equal measure. I'm not sure the Church of England is quite yet ready for four-hour ordination services in 85-degree heat. The celebration service for the anniversary was an hour longer laced with local music, ululation, joyful singing and a nun playing the vuvuzela! She played it again when we went to the convent for dinner one evening as part of the nuns' dancing and singing welcome – you had to be there really.

Alongside the joy is grinding poverty and a huge disparity of wealth. Whilst Tanzania is one of the most stable democracies in Africa, there is still widespread corruption and a poorly maintained infrastructure. It took us 13 hours to drive the 600 km from Dar Es Salaam to our Masasi hostel. Periods of fast driving were interspersed with bouncing through potholes almost as bad as South Shropshire.

It is easy to look at the Church in Tanzania with its spectacular growth, driven by genuine conversions to Jesus rather than church hopping, and think if only we transferred their patterns here we could have a similar experience. A simple transfer of methodology is unlikely to be successful. Culturally, English people are not as expressive. Similarly, we have such busy lives that 3-4 hour services with preaching of 45 minutes may not gain much traction.

The Christian message has always had to adapt as it moved from one culture to another through its history. Even the early churches described in the New Testament were very different from one another. There was conformity of belief, but great diversity of practice. The same is actually true in Tanzania depending on which UK missionary agency first brought the gospel to each part of the country. Even in the church of England, there is now a huge variation in congregational worship, even in the same parish. Perhaps the greatest lesson was not about a particular style, but the motivating question. In Tanzania it was 'how can we adapt our practice to make the message more accessible to those outside the Church so they can become followers of Jesus'? There don't seem to be many arguments about style of worship rooted in their personal preference. Mission comes first. Congregations are agents of community transformation. God is the one on whom they depend for everything, not a spiritual lifestyle accessory. I think all of us who visited found this profoundly challenging. I hope we all might also.

With best wishes

+ Richard

Kington Parishes: November 2026

Sunday, 1st ALL SAINTS

Revelations 7:9-end, Psalm 34:1-10, 1 John 3:1-3

10.00am:	Holy Communion/Patronal Festival:	Kington*
6.00pm:	Junior Praise:	Old Radnor
6.00pm:	Praise and Prayer Evening:	Kington

Sunday, 8th REMEMBRANCE SUNDAY

Amos 5:18-24 , Psalm 70, 1 Thessalonians 4:13-end, Luke 17:1-6 OR service books

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Huntington
10.00am:	Service of the Word + War Memorial:	Kington
10:45am	Holy Communion:	Old Radnor
10:45am	Remembrance Service:	Titley
6.00pm	Remembrance Service:	Kinnerton

Sunday, 15th 2 Before Advent

Zephania 1:7,12-end, Psalm 90: 1-8, 1Thessalonians 5:1-11, Matthew 25:14-30

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Morning Praise:	Kington*
12.30	Wild Church	Kington
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Old Radnor

Sunday, 22nd Christ the King

Ezekiel 34:11-16,20-24, Psalm 95:1-7, Ephesians 1:15-end, Matthew 25:3-end

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington*
6.00pm:	Sung Evensong:	Huntington

Sunday, 29th Advent Sunday

Isaiah 52:7-10, Psalm 19:1-6, Romans 10:12-18, Matthew 4:18-22

10.00am:	Benefice Communion:	Kinnerton
4.00pm:	Light up a Life:	Kington*

* These services are live streamed.

WEEKDAY SERVICES

Morning Prayer takes place at 9am in Kington every Monday, Wednesday and Friday, and Evening Prayer at 4pm on Mondays. All are welcome.

If you or a loved one are unable to make the services at St Mary's but would appreciate prayers or Communion by extension at home, please contact Phillippa (the Curate).

St. Mary's Church, Kington

As I write this, the leaves are still mostly on the trees, but I expect that by the time you read it, the branches will be bare, and we may have had some rain to water the fields and gardens… which brings us to our Harvest Festival. The bring and share lunch following this raised £100 for WaterAid. Thank you so much to all those who contributed in any way.

Community Shop
St. Mary's has the shop from Wednesday 18th November until Tuesday 24th. We will be setting up as usual from 6pm on Tuesday 17th November, and would be very grateful for any donations of goods to sell in the shop. Electrical items especially need to be donated on Tuesday or Wednesday morning, so that they can be PAT tested before sale. We will also be delighted with offers to help sell in the shop – there will be a rota in the church if anyone is able to offer a few hours. Do come along to see what bargains there are to be had this time…

Concert 15th November
Our latest concert will feature the Titley Philharmonic playing in church on Sunday 15th November at 3.30pm, followed by tea, coffee, and cake, and promises to be a really enjoyable occasion.

Curry Evening
This will be held on November 24th in the Parish Hall, from 7 – 9pm and will include a film about the persecuted church in Nigeria. There are more details elsewhere in this magazine. We hope some of you will be able to come along and enjoy a curry with us.

Coffee Morning
The second Dove and Yarn Barn coffee morning will be held on Saturday 21st November from 10am – 12noon. This will include a bring and buy, raffle, and a cake stall, as well as tea and coffee. Do come along. This will be regular occasion on the third Saturday of the month.



Having fun creating togther

All our usual activities have now restarted for the autumn, including Stay and Play in the Parish Hall on Tuesday mornings at 9.15.

With very best wishes from St. Mary's,
Margaret Cooke and Greg Wright, churchwardens.

BARNABAS AID
TUESDAY 24TH NOVEMBER 7-9 PM

Please come and join us for an evening of praying for the persecuted church

The evening will be led by Steffan Jones from Barnabas Aid.

We shall have a meal together and then watch a short video called Faith in the Fire, about Christian persecution in Nigeria.

The evening will finish with a time of prayer for the persecuted church.



St Thomas a Becket, Huntington

Huntington Chase 2026

On a glorious warm and sunny Autumn morning, 92 competitors entered this year's Chase in Huntington, either walking, running, cycling or riding. The 11 km course took them along road and track, over Hergest Ridge and down to Gladestry before confronting the steep incline at Stone House. Then, downhill all the way to the finish at The Swan in the village.

First in class were Kaz Miles on two wheels (improving on her time last year) and Emma Hallet on two legs, Talfryn Carter running in with a personal best and Rob Davies took first place for the second year on his bike. Jan Thomson riding Frankie led home the eleven horses in the field.

Sincere thanks go to the many helpers, supporters and contributors who enable the event to thrive and to The Swan Inn where the event concludes.

The Huntington Chase is run for fun, but it also raises funds for local charities, and this year The Dove Project will be the main beneficiary receiving £1,000. This is a new venture based in the former Wine Vaults in Kington High Street, providing a friendly, hospitable place for informal groups and meetings.

An amazing total of £1,620 was raised by the event, with the balance being donated to St Thomas a Becket Church in the village.

Peter Kelly

Date for your Diary
Village Hall Event – Afternoon Tea – Sunday 15th November 2026:

Afternoon Tea will be held on Sunday 15th November, to celebrate 30 years of the re-building/opening of the new village hall in Huntington. There will be lots of delicious food to enjoy, whilst chatting to friends and neighbours. There will also be a display of lots of old photos, which will no doubt bring back lots of memories for many, but will also be of interest to those who are new to Huntington. Hope you will be able to join us. Pippa Lloyd will e-mail further details in due course.

Susan Maiden





St. Peter's Church Titley

Readers

No first sunday service in November
Sunday 18th November Dick.

Charity Shop

I am pleased to report that the fantastic sum of £1800 was raised at the Charity Shop held recently for the Church and Village Hall. Many thanks to everyone who donated items to sell and to those who helped in the shop selling everything. Special thanks to Judith for pulling it all together. The money will now be divided between the Church and Hall.

Remembrance Sunday

This year Remembrance Day is on Sunday 8th November. As usual we will meet at the War Memorial at 10.30am to remember all of the people from Titley who gave their lives in the two wars so that we can enjoy the life we have today.

Village Christmas Party and Carol Service

Helen Boley has again agreed to organise the Village Christmas party which will this year be held at the Village Hall on Sunday 13th December from 12.30pm. This is always a great event packed with festive food and fun. Tickets are available from Helen by emailing titleychristmasparty@outlook.com or if you need to speak her number is 01544 231512. The cost is £25 for adults.

Like last year we are holding the Village Carol Service in Church the same evening at 6pm. What better way to finish the day off by singing all of the well-known carols. There may even be some punch left if we haven't drunk it all during the day!!

Christmas Day Service

There will be a service of Holy Communion on Christmas Day at 10am.

Many thanks

Dick

Saturday
14th November 7.30pm.
Music in New Radnor

The Bute Wind Quintet

Named after the beautiful Bute Park in Cardiff, The Bute Wind Quintet is an award-winning ensemble of Masters Graduates from the Royal Welsh College of Music and Drama. Tonight's programme consists mainly of works written especially for wind quintet and ranges from the elegance of Haydn and Taffanel, through the lyricism of Mervyn Burtch and James MacMillan, to the virtuosic pieces of György Ligeti, Jacques Ibert and Valerie Coleman.

New Radnor Community Hall,
Hall Lane, New Radnor, Powys,
LD8 2SW

Pre-booking preferred if possible
Tickets £15 (under 14s, £3)
from 01544 350746 or 07493 940683
Doors open at 7pm for a 7.30 start.

Glasses provided but please bring your own drinks

Reader Writes

Only a few years ago medics and nurses started asking if it was okay to use AI to assist with follow-up letters; trying to be obliging I always said, “of course, no problem”. But more recently I received a letter from a long-suffering consultant reporting that “this charming gentleman” came to see me! Issues of accuracy came to mind or was he up to mischief! It’s a big issue. Our website builder asks Claude and creative work is done. We assume these are early days, but we are in for a shock according to the drivers of the wildly advancing world of AI.

Elon Musk, in a long interview with the editor of The Economist, makes astonishing claims. According to Musk we are coming into an age of amazing abundance, and that humans won’t be in control in 10 years’ time. There’s much more! We face a 10-20% chance of killer robots wiping out humanity. His solution? Hope for the best and enjoy the ride! Yuval Noah Harari (Sapiens) argues that AI driven financial systems will take over the world (and enslave us?) and there will be mass produced intimacy (more slavery?).

We face a 10-20% chance of killer robots wiping out humanity. His solution? Hope for the best and enjoy the ride!

Archbishop Sarah Mullally, in a House of Lords debate in June this year, started from the point that God created human beings in his own image giving them inherent dignity and immeasurable value. Citing Hebrews 2:7-8 “You made them a little lower than the angels; you crowned them with glory and honour and put everything under their feet,” she establishes an essential human framework for considering the responsibilities of humans in a dangerous AI world. Pope Leo’s encyclical, Magnifica Humanitas, starts from here too. How will AI serve human flourishing in a spiritual framework? How should Christians respond as people choose chatbots over fellow human beings?

Sarah Mullally, the nurse, has the authority to say what her profession would say: there is no substitute for human contact when a mother gives birth to a child, when someone is dying and wants to make peace with their maker, or when we want to lay our shame before God and ask for forgiveness. Look in other directions; war (consider nuclear weapons) could outsmart all our defences. Or think Margaret Atwood’s Oryx and Crake for a deliberate pandemic. Sorry! I have some sympathy for Musk and hoping for the best. And climate change? Killer robots could solve the carbon problem overnight. The film The Matrix is terrifying, but Don’t Look Up was both terrifying and plausible.

Reader Writes is not into speculative fiction; the AI challenge is reality. As Christians we have to ask the big questions, do the hard work and bring it all before our Creator God. When Adam was placed in the Garden of Eden, we were made in God’s image, essentially creative. We have been crowned with a dignity and responsibility, within creation, to relate to God and man. That cannot let chatbots substitute for human relationships or allow profit and greed ahead of common humanity. We work, in partnership with God, to see his Kingdom come on earth. God’s church grows, and one day our Lord will come again. Make AI our servant and not a slave master. (Pete Killingley’s excellent short book on AI is reviewed separately.)

Robert MacCurrach

God by Numbers

11 I could have done with some help with this one. What on earth does God say about eleven? But as I searched and looked, I came increasingly to feel that, rather hidden from view, Number 11 was regarding me with mild amusement. There's a lurking idea beneath the more obvious scriptures. I think I am beginning to hear the Spirit's prompting.

Twelve is a very clear and celebrated robust number; and next month I'm sure we'll find lots to say about rounding off the twelfth and final God-by-Numbers. So, what's happened to eleven? Didn't Jacob have twelve sons, but everything seemed to go wrong? Joseph was the eleventh and, in a dream, he saw stars bowing down to him, and sheaves of barley gathering and bowing down. Consequently, he was hated by his brothers, and all the more so for being their father's favourite. So they sold him into slavery in Egypt. By this unexpected route God used Joseph, the eleventh son, to save his family and his people. As Joseph put it before his brothers: "You intended it to harm me, but God intended it for good …the saving of many lives." The lurking idea, in practice ever present, is that God uses the imperfect and the broken to bring healing and completeness.

Famously of course Judas betrayed our Lord and his fellow disciples. But God used the 11 disciples to establish his church. The imperfect, the broken, were used by God for his greatest works. It is through our flaws that we become most aware of our weakness. That very weakness, which we might think of as "elevenness" or "less-than-perfect-twelveness", makes us the useable vessels for God's Holy Spirit.

Robert MacCurrach and David Stearns

Deanery Roadshow!

Clergy, Church Wardens, Parish Officers, Deanery Synod and PCC Members and anyone else who would like to come are warmly invited to join us for the upcoming Deanery Roadshow!

Don't miss the opportunity to hear from our Archdeacon and our Director of Mission and Ministry about how the new strategy for Shared Local Ministry will work in our diocese.

This is an opportunity for worship and connection, time to ask questions and seek answers.

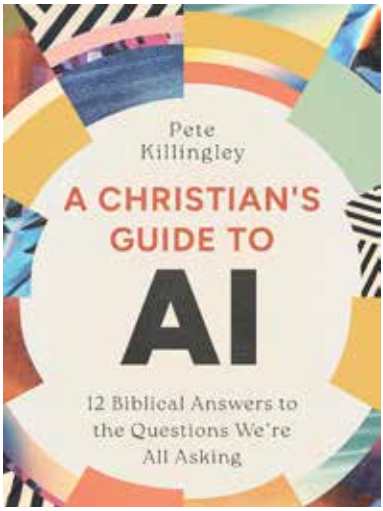
We look forward to welcoming you to this event.

Deanery Roadshow and Synod Meeting – Kington & Weobley

Where:
St Andrew's Church Presteigne

Date & Time:
Thursday 12th November 7pm – 9pm

Book review



Kington Christmas Art & Craft Market

Saturday 21st & 28th November
9:30 a.m. – 3:00 p.m.

Kington Market Hall and Place de Marines.

November see's the first 2 of our 4 Christmas Markets

It is the ideal place to find plenty of ideas, inspira4on, and a genuinely individual selec4on of original items so with Christmas not that far away why not pop along and see us? you never know you may find that ideal Christmas present.

We have a wide range of beautiful, hand-made cards, gifts and crafts to suit all tastes, ages and budgets.

All stalls feature genuinely handcrafted products,
by local Artists and Crafters including:

Cards for all occasions Pottery Basket making Alpaca products
Knitted and crocheted garments Paper-crafts Stone Engraving
Sewn products Local Honey plus many more.

Everyone welcome!

Dates for Our December Christmas Craft Markets are:

Saturday 12th December Saturday 19th December

A Christian's Guide To AI by Pete Killingley

After I'd written on AI in November Parish News, I came across Pete Killingley's small very helpful book: A Christian's Guide to AI, subtitled 12 Biblical Answers To The Questions We're All Asking. I recognize myself to be a digital luddite, and I know I'm in danger of falling behind in this important revolution. Many of us are beginning to use AI without realizing how deep into it we shall wade or eventually swim, very likely out of our depth and far from shore! This isn't a review of the book but a recommendation to find it and read it.

Pete Killingley is a pastor and preacher whose authority and argument I found helpful. His book is laid out in a way that that could be used as a study guide. Where do the boundaries lie? How do we relate to chatbots and distinguish truth and error in AI content? Can you make friends with AI, or can you use AI to create art? How could we or should we use AI for sermon preparation? What skills do we need to handle AI ethically and safely?

AI presents a big challenge to human society, and it presents special opportunities and responsibilities for Christians and churches. This book is helpful and worth reading, and useful as a reference.

Robert MacCurrach



THE DOVE

A friendly, hospitable place for informal groups and meetings, The Dove is based in the former 'Wine Vaults' pub right in the heart of Kington

We will offer a range of activities during the day and early evening which will be of benefit to the whole community.

Opening Tuesday 3 November

WEEKLY MEETINGS:

Tuesday 10.00 – 12.00
'Music @ The Dove'

Join our orchestra of enthusiastic musicians led by Julie Read.

Tuesday 2.00 – 3.00
Marches Voices

A Capella Choir singing madrigals and other unaccompanied songs. No audition but sightreading an advantage

Wednesday 10.00 – 12.00
Morning Coffee

Join us in The Dove for coffee, cake and a chat.

4th Wednesday includes Jigsaw Swap. All welcome!

Thursday 10.00 – 12.00
Toddler Group

Toast, toys and activities for under-4s

MONTHLY MEETINGS

1st Friday in the month Pause Café'

Enjoy good coffee, fresh cake and French conversation. All levels welcome.

The Cart Shed

The Cart Shed
Transforming Lives

The Cart Shed Charity works with adults and children experiencing mental health difficulties or who are struggling with their emotional wellbeing. Based in a woodland on a farm at Norton Canon, we use the principles of Occupational Therapy [finding meaning and purpose] alongside enriching and engaging activities such as green woodworking and coppice craft, horticulture and creative crafts to transform lives.

We are currently recruiting volunteer minibus drivers to enable people to access our services. If you would like to find out more about The Cart Shed Charity and our full range of volunteering opportunities, please contact Richard at info@thecartshed.co.uk or simply give us a call on 01544 318231. More information is available at www.thecartshed.co.uk. We would love to hear from you.

In aid of The Dove & Yarn Barn Renovations

Coffee Morning

at

The Dove & Yarn Barn
37 High St, Kington

10am - 12noon
Saturday 21st November

Coffee * Tea * Raffle
Bring & Buy * Tombola
Quiz * Cake Stall

Free Entry
All Welcome

MONTHLY MUSINGS

On the evening of 26th October 1605, Lord Monteagle was dining at home with friends when a servant came in with a letter. He said it had been handed him in the street by a tall man, with strict instructions to give it to his master without delay. Lord Monteagle took it, broke the seal and read a strange anonymous warning. Here's the gist as I've put it into verse form.

THE LETTER

Dear Lord Monteagle, take care, I you pray,
and from Parliament House on the 5th keep away;
Of the love that I bear to your friends, I advise,
as you care for your life, some excuse then devise.

God and mankind now together conspire
to punish the wicked – then to safety retire
and await the event, for though nothing yet show,
there shall come, at this parliament, a terrible blow!

Mark well this letter, it may do you good,
Of harm it bears nothing; observe it you should.
And when you have burned it, all danger is past.
And may God of his grace bring you safe home at last.

Lord Monteagle wasted no time in bringing the letter before the Privy Council and King James, who at once suspected gunpowder (for his own father had been blown up!). The Houses of Parliament were searched, but nothing was found. It was just before midnight on 4th November when Sir Thomas Knyvet, with a small band of men, apprehended Guido Fawkes and laid bare the Gunpowder Plot in the nick of time! They discovered, in the basement, 36 barrels of powder with 3 matches and tinder for the fuse. At four o'clock in the morning the King was awoken and told the news, and the hunt was on!

The plotters were rounded up. The lucky ones were shot. Others were captured, tortured until they confessed, and then hung, drawn and quartered. Guido Fawkes was hanged, not burned, yet every year at this time, we light our fires and burn his effigy. And what was it all about? Religion! It's amazing to consider how much violence, evil, hatred and so on have been wrought in the name of the King of Love! Yet in some ways it is not so surprising. What we believe about Jesus is so important that it's hard not to get worked up and become quite intolerant of folk who think differently from ourselves. The plotters who supported Guido Fawkes thought they were doing God's work – restoring the one and only true Catholic church in Britain – whereas James and his Parliament intended also to do God's work, by putting down a wicked Popish plot! The result was hatred and violence in the Name of Christ!

Jesus said, "Judge not that ye be not judged". We are perhaps more tolerant than they were in the seventeenth century, but we've a long we to go, myself included, before we can honestly sing, "We are not divided, all one body we!"

Dennis Parry

From Lady Hawkins School

Choosing the right secondary school is an exciting and important decision, and what better way to discover what school life is really like than by hearing from someone who experiences it every day? In this special Open Evening feature, one of our Year 11 students shares his personal experience of his educational journey at Lady Hawkins' School, offering an insight into the opportunities, friendships and challenges that make school life so rewarding. We hope you enjoy Tristan Collier's speech.

Miss Moss

Change. The act or result of something becoming different, according to the Oxford dictionary. It is quite the paradox, a word that conjures both hope and fear, a word that can mean everything or nothing. Now, while it is all very well me droning on and trying to distil 4 years of my life into a piece of paper, I would prefer to talk about the huge change that hits, has hit, or will hit all of us- secondary school. It has been quite the experience. There have been trips to the other side of the world, sporting events, clubs rise and have fallen, the opportunity to try work experience with a filming company, which certainly has affected me for the better. Of course, it wasn't all smooth sailing. There have been deadlines, exams, and all the changes that came with coming to high school.

Things change rapidly in school, too. The relaxed daily tutor sessions before break turned into twice weekly coaching sessions- of course not sports coaching, but more emotional sessions. Even from year 10 to 11, a lot has happened. GCSEs are now close. That's change. I became a head student, and while I do enjoy it, it has placed me here in front of you to talk on and on. Sorry about that, but that's change. Even the sudden responsibility of being year 11 is change. The point I am making is this- change is treated with an irrational fear when put into certain contexts, such as the move from primary to secondary education. That is a huge change for everyone involved- the student, the parents, siblings, primary school teachers, secondary school teachers, their fellow classmates and the wider school are all affected by this change. Does that mean we should be afraid of it? I don't think so. Change is natural, unpredictable, and constant. But that does not make it a bad thing.

So, as I run out of time in my speech, I am not going to simply tell all our possible new students to not be afraid. There is little point in me doing that, as fear of change is as unnatural as change itself. Instead, I will tell them that change happens, is happening, and will happen again. So, embrace it. Dive headfirst into the next stage of your lives. Roll the dice one more time. Because you will do incredible things, and that I guarantee you all.

Tristan Collier

November

Please get in touch if your group is within a 10 mile radius of Kington and would like to be added to a small waiting list who will be offered any vacancies as they arise

KINGTON & DISTRICT Community Shop

Rita Langford
01544 230562

Adrian Wilcox
kingtoncommunityshop@outlook.com

Kington & District Community Shop

04-Nov	New Radnor Castle Mound Trust
11-Nov	Pembridge Primary School
18-Nov	Friends of St Mary's
25-Nov	Newchurch Church



St Mary's Church

'Light up a Life'

Remembering those we love but see no longer

Sunday 29th November, 4.00 p.m.

Stars will be available in church for you to write
the name of a loved one that you remember.
A donation of £2.50 per star will go to St Michael's Hospice.



Trefoil Guild
Kington



The Trefoil Guild is a friendly community for anyone aged 18+ who enjoys friendship, fun, food and fellowship. Whether you've been involved in Guiding before or are simply looking for a friendly group to join, you are very welcome to come along.

Our next meeting will be a day event at one of our members homes in Lyonshall on **Saturday 28th November from 10.00am–4.00pm**. During the day we will be doing a range of fun activities, games and crafts, along with welcome pastries, a bring-your-own lunch, and afternoon cake. Please contact Sally on the details below for more information and for details about our Christmas lunch in December.

sally@leitch.me.uk or 07765 056386

Not a Proper Gardener



Walking down by the river this morning, 5th October, we noticed how shallow it is, in spite of the arrival of a little rain recently, and we wondered how long it will be before we have a decent rainfall. Emma reminded me that El Niño is forecast to be exceptionally strong this autumn/winter, causing spells of very rough, stormy weather, disastrous in some parts of the world and likely to cause widespread flooding here. Ah well! we shall see. We can only speculate and hope for the best, and meanwhile, be thankful for at least some reprieve from the damaging drought we have suffered this year.

So here's some good garden news in no particular order: (1) Giles' assiduous collection of cobnuts has meant that he's beaten the squirrel to it this year. He's become adept at husking them and even more proficient at eating them – as quickly as Emma can use the nutcrackers! (2) Where Emma forgot to chop up some spent broad bean haulms she had thrown by the compost heap, some lovely fresh plants have sprung up! Shall we get a late harvest from them? (3) Surprisingly the rhubarb is the best ever, late but juicy and, stewed, a delicious dessert with ice cream. (4) the sunflowers have been, and still are, a brilliant splash of real joy. (5) Other crops which survived or revived from those terrible heatwaves include runner beans, kale, sprouting broccoli, courgettes, plums, damsons and enough pears. There were not many apples to store for the winter, but those that made it were sweet and juicy despite the lack of water.

And what of the livestock? Well, the reason why we harvested only three small cucumbers was that a saucy blackbird took possession of the greenhouse, and when Emma came to shoo it out, it flew and perched at the door, tweeting at the top of its voice, "I'm the king of the castle, and you're the dirty rascal!" The naughty creature repeatedly dug up the cucumber plants and scraped and scratched the soil everywhere and all over the path. It's meant Emma has been having to find a way of making the place blackbird-proof yet ventilated as she prepares to plant some salads for the winter. She's done what she can, cleaned it all out and incorporated several bags of manure into the soil, hoping for the best!

The rest of the birds are spoilt by Emma, who spends all her pocket money on food hygienically fed to them. The sparrows do pretty well, though the sparrowhawk is a threat they could do without. The little robin is a favourite. A bit fastidious about its food, it comes close, cocks its head imploringly and profitably awaits special treatment.

We have not again seen all five hedgehogs together, but we hope they are all doing well. The calci worms are providing a nourishing diet for them.

Happy gardening, Denis.

For all advertising enquiries please contact:
pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

OAK | Open Arms Kington November events



Events and opening at The Oxford Arms, Kington, November 2026.
Details for all events on our website (openarmskington.co.uk).
Tel: 07301081444, email info@openarmskington.co.uk.

Wednesday 4th November, 10am-12.30pm. *Sunflower Social at Places of Welcome.* A hidden disabilities support group and network, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the first Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Saturday 7th November, 10am-1pm *Art and craft with a Radnor Lily twist* to celebrate Diwali. Art activities for all ages and abilities. Free.

Wednesday 11th November, 10am-12.30pm. *Dementia Matters at Places of Welcome.* Support group and network for people affected by dementia, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the second Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Saturday 14th November, from 5pm. *DJ night with DJ ODAAT.* Music from 7pm. Free.

Sunday 22nd November. *Workshops with artist David Blandy,* in association with Meadow Arts. For further details please see our website.

Sunday 29th November, 2-4pm. *Creative Workshop*. This month's activity is embossed Christmas tree decorations. Payment by donation (£5 suggested). Bar and café open 12-4pm.

OAK | Open Arms Kington CiC www.openarmskington.co.uk comms@openarmskington.co.uk

St Mary's Church Kington

TITLEY PHIL BAROQUE ORCHESTRA

Director: David Hatcher

Sunday 15th November 3.30

Bach: Concerto for Two Harpsichords

Paul Roberts & Raymond Fearn - Harpsichords

Handel: Overtures

Organ music by Bach & Pachelbel

Tickets at the door: £12.00 (including tea)

News From the Museum

Horse Hair

We have all heard of horsehair being used as stuffing in chairs and chaise lounges, for violin bows, judges' wigs and soldiers' plumes, also as stuffing for other furniture. As early as 1760 hair was regarded as an elegant luxury fabric, when Thomas Chippingham covered his library salon dining chairs in horsehair fabric. By 1789 Hepplewhite described the high gloss patterns and stripes and plain horsehair fabrics as being the best for use with mahogany chairs as it was durable, valuable and easy to clean.

There were many factories making horsehair fabric taking over from the cottagers' who started weaving by hand. As fashion and machinery came into use the horses would have their tails docked to avoid them getting tangled up in the machinery they were using. Health and Safety with recycling thrown in. The hair would be washed, combed through a hackle (a long sharp needle on a wooden base) over and over to remove any tangles or knots before bleaching, and dyeing ready for use. The next process was after washing, to clamp bundles of hair together ready for the steel picker to squeeze out the water. The groove at the end of the picker acted like a pair of tweezers removing one strand at a time, ready to go into a rapier which acted as shuttle on the loom. The hair was the weft thread and the warp would be of cotton or silk thread.

The cloth would be woven the length of the hair, which was mixed as the hair strand was thinner one end than the other. It was a female workforce with children threading one hair in at a time into the looms their mothers operated, but by 1870 the Education Act came to provide compulsory schools and so speeded up mechanisation in the factories.

As the modern materials and synthetics arrived horsehair cloth went out of fashion. By this time there was only one factory left weaving and that was in Castle Carey Ireland, as the one in Somerset would weave but also had made. How to reinvent themselves?

There were three basic styles sateen with mostly horsehair showing the one side, a repeat with the hair showing both sides and damask with a woven pattern.

The company continued in business making handbags, supplying material for the interior designers, decorators and antiques restorers.

Where does the horsehair come from today? The horses and ponies are still used in agriculture in the Far East and China having their tails docked as they did centuries ago, but it is only hair from live horses that can be used as dead hair is brittle and impossible to dye.

There are examples to be found of the furniture with horsehair fabric in Downing Street, American Museum in Bath and of course in the Victoria and Albert Museum.

Wendy Jones

KINGTON COMMUNITY LUNCH CLUB

Come and enjoy a 2-course meal in a friendly environment with other local seniors at:

Kington Parish Hall

(HR5 3AG)

at 12:30 p.m.

Cost is £6

We meet on the

3rd Wednesday of each month.

Next lunch is on 18th November

Contact: Sarah: 01544 598125

Brilley Flicks in the Sticks & Live Perfomance

Thursday 5th November at 7.30: The Trouble with Jessica (15), £5

A British satirical dark comedy about successful professional London couple Sarah and Tom, who are in deep financial trouble. Their situation takes a terrifying nosedive with the shocking behaviour of uninvited dinner guest, Jessica. Faced with the moral dilemma of their lives - and dragging their best friends Richard and Beth with them - they make a series of choices that could either be their salvation or destruction.

And looking ahead:

Thursday 3rd December at 7.30: Midwinter Break (12A), £5

Thursday 7th January at 7.30: Rebuilding (PG), £5

Brilley and Michaelchurch Village Hall (HR3 6JG), doors open at 7pm. Don't forget to bring your own refreshments!

As usual advance booking only - please book and pay for your tickets online at pay-brilley.co.uk



Easy Sudoku

		4	1					
		9	4				2	
		2	6			3		8
	6		8	4	3		9	
2	8	5				4	3	1
4	9		2	1	5		8	
3		6			9	5		
	2				1	9		
					4	8		

Intermediate Sudoku

6						2		4
			3				6	
	1			4				
		9				7	8	
		2	1		5	6		
	8	4				1		
				2			1	
	5				7			
4		8						3

Please see page 22 for answers

Caring for God's Acre

Evergreen Immortals: Yew tree Folklore

In St George's Churchyard in Clun, Shropshire, stands a marvelous sight to behold. Estimated to be around 2,000 years old, lives a majestic ancient Yew tree. As the oldest tree in Shropshire, this beautiful specimen has likely bore witness to rich history. It has stood tall, guarding the churchyard since medieval times. If it could speak, it would surely have some stories to tell.

There are many Yews across the UK standing strong in churchyards and burial grounds, each with their own unique stories and heritage. The English Yew, Taxus baccata, is an evergreen tree that is commonly found in and associated with churchyards. Some are hundreds and even thousands of years old. Many of these Ancient Yews likely predate the churchyards they are found in, and have strong ties to Pagan, Celtic and Druidic traditions.

Yews are steeped in rich and sometimes dark folklore. They are known as the "tree of the dead" for several reasons. It is thought that these trees were planted in sacred places to watch over the dead and guide their passage to the other side. The species is known for its longevity and habit of rooting from drooping branches that touch the ground, further cementing its lore of being a tree of death and rebirth. All parts of the tree are toxic to humans, and even feature in Shakespeare's Scottish play, where a poisonous concoction featuring Yew berries is made.

The Kingley Vale Yews have a spooky local history. Legends say there was a great battle between local people and invading Vikings



and when the local soldiers fell, their bodies were buried in the forests where the Yew trees now stand. The forests are supposedly haunted by the soldiers, who possess the Yews and come alive at night. We can't forget to mention the Bleeding Yews of Nevern Church in Pembrokeshire. These Yews appear to be continuously bleeding red sap from their trunks. Many legends and myths have arisen to explain this phenomenon, but one endearing explanation is that they bleed in sympathy with Jesus and his crucifixion. Nevertheless, Yews all over the UK will likely live on for hundreds more years, passing down their stories, legends and history forevermore.

If you find yourself with one of these majestic trees in your churchyard, here are a few things you can do to help them out. Most Yews don't need much management and generally like to be left alone. However, clearing anything over their root plate and underneath the trees as well as any ivy growing up the trunk will give them the best conditions to thrive. Get thinking about how you can involve your local communities with our Love Your Yew Week in Feb 2027. To find out more, follow the link to our website to read why Yews are so important to churchyards and how you can help them today.

Kaitlyn Elverson
Engagement Officer,
Nature in Sacred Places Project (NiSP)

KINGTON TOWN COUNCIL UPDATE

November update

The past few weeks have seen change at the council with two, long serving councillors leaving after many years of service to the town. Both Martin Fitton and Tom Bounds have been involved with the Town council over the years and willingly given of their time and expertise. We wish them well for the future.

One door closes and another one opens and we have welcomed three new councillors to our ranks, Patrick Conrad, Martin Blackaller and Len Timmins all bring new experience and expertise to the council and we look forward to working with them.

On the work front works are underway to the Market Hall, Place des Marines and Coach house. Whilst these things always take longer than hoped, it will be good to see the building back in a good state of repair. Other works have been completed to the pavements in Bridge Street, and we are waiting to hear when the new lighting can be installed on the bridge.

Our biggest project, at the moment, concerns the acquisition of the public toilets in the Place des Marines. These are currently owned and maintained by Herefordshire council and are a constant cause for concern in the town. The Town Council would like to take control of this to take the management and cleanliness issues under our control. Needless to say, it is a long process but one that is now underway.

I would welcome any feedback you have on any of the above or indeed other matters that the council might be able to look at. I can be contacted on cllr.m.woolford@kingtontowncouncil.gov.uk

Martin Woolford
Mayor: Kington Town Council

Motorcycles Galore

In 1946 the family moved from Compton Bassett in Wiltshire to Tormarton in South Gloucestershire. Public transport was unheard of. Cycling or walking was the only way of getting around unless you owned a car, motorcycle or bicycle. Not easy to find or buy any of these forms of transport new because of the export drive.



My first motorized form of transport was a Corgi scooter with a 98cc motor, top speed 25 miles per hour. I exchanged the Corgi for a 1936 150cc Francis Barnett. This had a hand change gear lever on the right-hand side of the petrol tank. Changing gear was an art in itself!

One day the chain guard was working loose and rattling. I returned home and removed the guard. Setting off again suddenly the clutch mechanism flew off narrowly missing my left shin. Another weary bike pushing journey home refitted the guard and all was well.

During my motorcycling days I became the proud owner of an OEC two stroke Villiers engined OEC. I was on my way to RAF Melksham to attend a demob party for a good friend, Jock Howie. I never made it; the engine blew up at a crossroads near Tormarton some two miles from home on my outward journey. We met up later in Edinburgh. I travelled up to Scotland with a friend on a 500 cc AJS in the middle of March – but that's another story.

Tony Jardine.

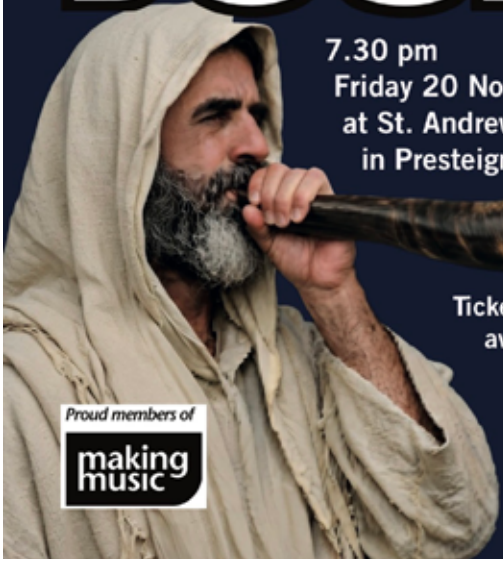
KCS KINGTON CHORAL SOCIETY

Kington Choral Society with the Marches Camerata conducted by Simon Harper

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George Frideric Handel's

JOSHUA

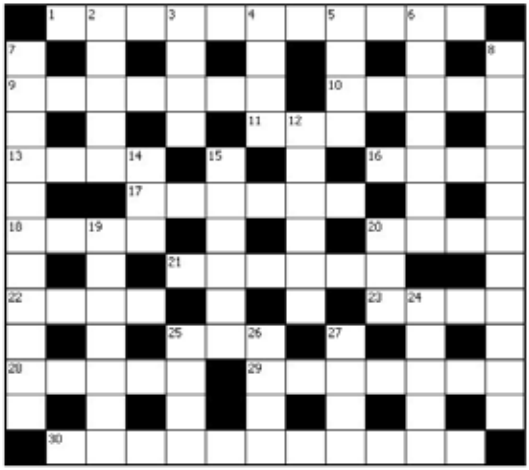


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November Crossword



Down

2 ‘O Jerusalem _ how _I have longed to gather your children together’ Matthew 23:37) (5)

3 Way out (4)

4 Exhort (Romans 12:1) (4)

5 Done (anag.) (4)

6 Highest of the four voice-parts in a choir (7)

7 Concerning the study of God (11)

8 Uniquely, it has Abbey, Cathedral and Chapel (11)

12 Admonish (Matthew 16:22) (6)

14 Frozen (3)

15 Established form of religious ceremony (6)

19 Inscription often found on gravestones (7)

20 See 1 Across

24 Behaved (Joshua 7:1) (5)

25 Time (anag.) (4)

26 Lists choice of meals (4)

27 ‘For the wages of sin is death, but the _ of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord’(Romans 6:23) (4)

Across

1 and 20 Down ‘Lord of all _, Lord of all _, whose trust, ever child-like, no cares could destroy’(11,3)

9 Mosesí question to a fighting Hebrew labourer: ‘Why are you _ your fellow Hebrew?” (Exodus 2:13) (7)

10 Acclaimed cellist who contracted multiple sclerosis at the height of her fame, Jacqueline _ (2,3)

11 ‘At even _ the sun was set, the sick, O Lord, around thee lay’(3)

13 A descendant of Gad (xNumbers 26:16) (4)

16 ‘Do not leave Jerusalem, but _ for the gift my Father promised’ (Acts 1:4) (4)

17 Clambers (Jeremiah 48:44) (6)

18 Peter’s response to questioning by the Sanhedrin: ‘We must _God rather than men!’(Acts 5:29) (4)

20 Christian paraplegic author, artist and campaigner, _ Eareckson Tada (4)

21 Bird partial to the nests of other birds (6)

22 ‘Such large crowds gathered round him that he got into a boat and sat _ _ ‘(Matthew 13:2) (2,2)

23 Infectious tropical disease (4)

25 Tree (3)

28 ‘No fear of me should _ you, nor should my hand be heavy upon you’(Job 33:7) (5)

29 For example, to Titus, Timothy or Philemon (7)

30 Week beginning with Pentecost Sunday, according to the Church’s calendar (11)

Please see page 22 for answers

Answers Page

Easy Sudoku

8	7	4	1	3	2	6	5	9
6	3	9	4	5	8	1	2	7
1	5	2	6	9	7	3	4	8
7	6	1	8	4	3	2	9	5
2	8	5	9	7	6	4	3	1
4	9	3	2	1	5	7	8	6
3	4	6	7	8	9	5	1	2
5	2	8	3	6	1	9	7	4
9	1	7	5	2	4	8	6	3

Intermediate Sudoku

6	9	3	7	1	8	2	5	4
2	4	7	3	5	9	8	6	1
8	1	5	6	4	2	3	9	7
1	6	9	2	3	4	7	8	5
7	3	2	1	8	5	6	4	9
5	8	4	9	7	6	1	3	2
9	7	6	4	2	3	5	1	8
3	5	1	8	9	7	4	2	6
4	2	8	5	6	1	9	7	3

Crossword

■	H	O	P	E	F	U	L	N	E	S	S	■
T	■	F	■	X	■	R	■	O	■	O	■	W
H	I	T	T	I	N	G	■	D	U	P	R	E
E	■	E	■	T	■	E	R	E	■	R	■	S
O	Z	N	I	■	R	■	E	■	W	A	I	T
L	■	■	C	L	I	M	B	S	■	N	■	M
O	B	E	Y	■	T	■	U	■	J	O	N	I
G	■	P	■	C	U	C	K	O	O	■	■	N
I	N	I	T	■	A	■	E	■	Y	A	W	S
C	■	T	■	E	L	M	■	G	■	C	■	T
A	L	A	R	M	■	E	P	I	S	T	L	E
L	■	P	■	I	■	N	■	F	■	E	■	R
■	W	H	I	T	S	U	N	T	I	D	E	■

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41

	41	41	41	41	41	41
	M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
Kington Mill St	06:10	08:20	10:10	12:10	15:20	17:30
Titley	06:18	08:28	10:19	12:19	15:19	17:39
Knighton Bus Station	06:40	-	10:48	12:45	15:55	18:05
Knighton Library		08:53	10:54	12:47	15:57	-

36

	41	41	41	41	41	41
	M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
Knighton Offa's Dyke	06:38	09:07	11:09	13:03	16:13	18:03
Knighton Bus Staion	06:42	09:11	11:13	13:07	16:17	18:07
Titley	07:04	09:35	11:35	13:34	16:39	18:27
Kington Mill St	07:14	09:45	11:45	13:44	16:49	18:37

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Monday to Sunday

	461 M>F	461 C	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 Sun	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	462 M>Sa	461 Sun	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 Sun	461 S Hol	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	
Llandrindod Wells																		
Railway Station		06:38			09:00			11:08	12:08		13:08	14:08			16:00	18:50		
Crossgates		06:44			09:06			11:14	12:14		13:14	14:14			16:11	18:56		
Kington. Mill St *arr*		07:13			09:45			11:45	12:45		13:45	14:45			16:46	19:22		
Kington, Mill St *dep*	06:40		07:20	08:50	09:50	09:50	10:50	11>50	12:50	12:50	13:50	14:50	15:50	15:50	17:10	19:37	22:00	
Hereford Old Market	07:32		08:30	09:47	10:53	10:53	11:47	12:47	13:49	13:46	14:47	15:47	16:49	16:53	18:02	20:24	Request	
Hereford Station	07:37		08:35	09:52	10:58	10:58	11:52	12:52	13:55	13:58	14:52	15:52	16:55	16:58	18:07	20:27	Request	

	461 M>Sa	461 M>F	461 M>Sa	462 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 Sun	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 Sun	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	861 Sch W	461 Sch	461 M>Sa	461 Sun	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa
Hereford Station		07:38	09:00	10:00	11:00	11:00	12:00	13:00	14:00	14:00	15:00	16:00	16:15	16:30	17:00	17:00	18:15	20:45
Hereford Maylord		07:42	09:07	10:07	11:07	11:07	12:07	13:07	14:07	14:07	15:07	16:07	16:25	16:37	17:07	17:07	18:22	20:52
Kington Mill St *arr*		08:45	10:05	11:10	12:05	12:09	13:05	14:05	15:05	15:09	16:05	17:05	17:10	17:35	18:05	18:09	19:20	21:48
Kington Mill St *dep*	07:50		10:10	11:10	12:10		13:10	14:10			16:10	17:15h		17:35	18:10			
Crossgates	08:21		10:41	11:41	12:41		13:41	14:41			16:41	17:45h		18:06	18:41			
Llandrindod Wells Station	08:39		10:47	11:47	12:55		13:47	14:47			16:55	17:52h		18:12	18:47			

Key:

M>Sa	Monday to Saturday
Sun	Sundays only
C	Operates Hereford College days only
S Hol	School holidays M>F
h	School holidays + Sat

Please verify with Sargeants for the most up to date timings and if Sunday buses are running on the route you require.

Forthcoming events

November Time	*Event*	*Venue & Contact*
Sun 1st 6.00 pm	Prayer and Praise Evening	St Mary's
Mon 2nd 12.15 – 1.00pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
Repeated Weekly		
Tues 3rd 2 – 3pm	Marches Voices Choir (all welcome)	Parish Hall
Repeated Weekly		
Tues 3rd 7.00pm	St Mary's PCC	Parish Hall
Thurs 5th 10.00 – 12.00	Toddle Time	The Dove, Kington High Street
Every Thurs in term time	(Parents, carers and children aged 0 – 3)	
Fri 6th 10.00– 11.00am	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
Repeated Weekly		
Fri 6th 11.30 – 13.30	Kington Food Bank	Parish Hall
Repeated Weekly		
Tues 10th 7.00pm	Beetle Drive	Parish Hall
Sun 8th 10.00am	Remembrance Day Service followed by Parade	St Mary's Church
Sat 14th Daytime	St Mary's Vision Day	St Mary's Church
Sun 15th 3.30pm	Titley Phil Orchestra Concert & Organ Recital £12 including tea	St Mary's Church
18th – 23rd 9.30 – 4 pm	St Mary's Church @ Kington Community Shop	Community Shop
Wed 18th 3.30pm	Lego Club	St Mary's
Thurs 26th 6.00 pm	Kington Christmas Lights	Kington To be confirmed
Sun 22nd 6.00pm	Choral Evensong (rehearsal 5.00 pm, tea 5.30)	Huntington Church
Sun 29th 10.00am	Advent Sunday Combined Benefice Service	Kinnerton

NB No service at St Mary's

Sun 29th 4.00pm	'Light up a Life' St Michael's Hospice Service	St Mary's Church

FOR DETAILS OF CHURCH SERVICES PLEASE SEE KINGTON PARISHES PAGE 3

You can also find details of many cultural events and activities in Broad Sheep: www.broadsheep.com and www.visitherefordshire.co.uk

If you would like a church or community event publicised in the Diary please contact the Diary Editor: Rev.Paul.C.Roberts@gmail.com

MATERIAL FOR THE DECEMBER 2026 PARISH NEWS
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Please send by email (maximum 500 words) to:
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